

music

Moving Strains

Music has the power to take one to a different plane and when it is film music of bygone era, one is transported not just to a different plane but to a different era. Such is the power of film music and of the soulful melodies of geniuses like Madan Mohan, Naushad, Anil Biswas and S.D. Burman, to name just a few, that they can melt the toughest of hearts. From 1931 to 2008, film music has progressed through various phases from classical to folk, western, rock 'n' roll, disco, to the current trend of hip-hop and remixes. But despite such a rich tradition, very little of any significance has been written on music in Indian films. For instance, who were the musicians who evolved a particular form or led to the transformation from one genre to another, the anecdotes behind the numerous songs. The answers to these questions are difficult to find as the growth of film music has not been documented properly. "These are stories

to be told and retold. They make sense of film music," says Shubha Mudgal, classical singer and composer. Now however, there is a sudden rush by publishing houses to bring out books on film music—*The Playback in Malayalam Cinema* by Kiran Ravindran and *Hindi Film: Music Song Beyond Boundaries* by Ashok Da Ranade to name a few.

Ravindran's book traces the history of music starting from the first film, *Balan* (1938), and lists the contributions made by music composers, lyricists and singers who have enriched Malayalam cinema. Through painstaking research that included personal interviews and sourcing songs, he has brought out a fascinating collection of profiles and the trends that shaped Malayalam cinema. What is remarkable is last annexure where he has compiled a long list of songs which are based on ragas. Unlike Ravindran, Ranade analyses music composers and voices and gives insight into the historical developments and discusses aesthetic issues of film music. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

VOICES OF INDIA: Yesudas and Lata Mangeshkar (right)



RAGHU RAI

art

Different Strokes

MUMBAI It's an art show, but with a difference. Three Dimensions in Art, a collaborative effort by Samsara and Angel Arts, will bring together various artists like Gurcharan Singh, Ajay De, Sanatan Dinda, Sanat Kar, Sakti Burman and Jogen Chaudhury, to name a few, on a common platform. The variety in their approach, both the medium and the method, is reflected in their works. The artists, through their canvases and sculptures, have woven a story to convey the underlying message of this show: encourage exploration in modern art and contemporary sculpture. And to add to this, connoisseurs of art can also participate in a wine appreciation course on the last two days of the exhibit. Also on display will be the works of a new artist, Varun Kapoor—the "artist at work"—who will give guests a preview into the journey of creating a masterpiece. At Out of the Blue Gallery, Bandra, from June 13 to 15. **by Swati Mathur**

COMPASSION: A work by Ajay De



festival

Mystic Melody

DELHI Every year Osho World dedicates a week to pay homage to the wisdom and devotion of the mystic poet Kabir. Beginning June 13, a series of events like daily meditation sessions and musical renditions of his poetry will be held. A set of DVDs of Osho discourses on Kabir will also be released



Agarawal

on the occasion. Don't miss Rashmi Agarawal's rendition of Kabir's poetry on June 18. Till June 19 at Osho World Galleria, Ansal Plaza.